PSYC 3303 Topic Proposal

Purpose:

As stated in the syllabus, you are required to complete a 10-to-12 page paper on a chosen topic of interest that is pertinent to the field of psychology. The purpose of this assignment is to help you begin your research process early! In addition, completing this assignment will allow me to verify that your topic of interest is appropriate for this class and something that is feasible to complete this semester.

Topic Proposal Requirements:

You will provide ***two*** topics of interest. I would strongly recommend that the topics be of personal and academic interest (writing is much easier when you find the subject matter interesting!). In other words, not only should you be excited to learn more about your topic, but completion of this paper should provide you with some additional advantage. For example, this paper might serve as preparation for work in either PSYC 4503 or PSYC 4703, an undergraduate thesis, or a foundation for later academic work in graduate school.

****Once you have identified your two topics of interest, you are required to write a brief proposal for each topic. In your topic proposals, you should address the following points:****

1. **What is your topic, and why have you selected it?**
    - What are the personal/academic advantages of pursuing this topic? You should also comment on your current familiarity with the topic area

2. **What will be the purpose of this paper?**
    - This is the most important part of this assignment! First, it is impossible to write a well-structured paper without clearly stating your purpose. Second, you are likely to find a large amount of information on any given topic. A clear purpose statement will allow you to parse through this information so you can be selective and only select sources that include appropriate information.

3. **What is the title of this paper?**
    - The title should be concise. In other words, make it brief but capture the purpose of the paper.

4. **What sources have you identified for this paper?**
    - This is the second most important part! What articles have you found so far? (Please list four articles for each topic (8 total) – remember, your final paper will need at least 10 sources!).
    - Remember, only articles published in **PEER REVIEWED JOURNALS** will count! This means no Wikipedia, no psych today, no random internet websites, etc. If you aren't sure whether an article is peer reviewed, please ask me!
        i. For each article you select as a source, please list:
            1. The author(s) and publication year
            2. The title and journal
            3. Which topic this source is for?
            4. What database you used to find this source?
            5. The abstract (you can copy and paste this)

5. **Please indicate which of the two topics you would prefer to write about.**
    - When possible, I will try to accommodate your preferred topic. However, your second choice will be selected if (1) your first choice has already been selected by another student or (2) your second choice provides a stronger paper, has a clearer purpose, has stronger sources, etc.

A final note: Remember, you need to propose TWO topics! Do each step twice (once per topic). If you only propose one topic, you will lose 50% of the point value for this assignment.

This assignment is due on 9/12. Please submit via D2L!